12 Ways to Make Money on Instagram in Canada (2026): Complete Guide to Monetizing Your Account

Instagram · 12 Ways · Canada · 2026 • Updated November 2, 2026



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Quick Answer: Yes, you can make money on Instagram in Canada through Instagram Subscriptions, brand partnerships and sponsored content, gifts from fans via Stars, Instagram Shops, affiliate marketing, selling your own merchandise, creating user-generated content (UGC), promoting your own business, offering Instagram marketing consulting, selling online courses, Instagram Live badges, and the Creator Marketplace. Earnings range from $10 to $100 per post for nano influencers (under 10,000 followers) to $5,000 to $10,000 per post for macro influencers (100,000 to 1 million followers). Canadians can monetize Instagram, but some features like Subscriptions require a professional account with at least 10,000 followers, and gifts require at least 500 followers. Instagram pays out in USD to Canadian creators via direct deposit or PayPal, and all income is taxable in Canada.

Introduction: Can You Really Make Money on Instagram in Canada?

With around 20 million Canadian users, Instagram is one of the most popular social media platforms in Canada. And while it's great for sharing photos and videos of your dream vacation or restaurant meals, you can also use the Instagram app to make extra cash—either as a side hustle or potentially as a new career.

Here are 12 ways to make money on Instagram in Canada.

Whether you're a creator with a growing following, a small business owner looking to reach new customers, or someone just starting out on the platform, there are multiple monetization paths available to Canadian users. The key is understanding which options fit your follower count, content niche, and long-term goals.

Top Picks at a Glance

Play Games & Take Surveys

Freecash

$40 Reward

Access a variety of tasks

Make an average of $300 per offer

Get a $10 CAD sign-up bonus when you start your first offer

Best for Mobile

Testerup

Earn up to $800 through offers

No limit on how much you play games or complete surveys

Earn money while playing games

Paid Surveys

LEO (Leger Opinion)

Earn up to $100 per month in rewards

Free, user-friendly, and secure app and website

1. *Sell Subscriptions*

How much you can make: US$0.99 – US$99.99 per Subscription.

How it works: With Instagram Subscriptions, you can offer exclusive content and experiences to your followers. You can host exclusive Lives, host chats for up to 30 subscribers, and share subscriber-only posts and Reels. Subscribers pay a monthly fee, providing ongoing income for you, and they also get a special badge to help their comments stand out.

What to Watch Out For

Requires a professional account with at least 10,000 followers

Instagram takes a percentage of subscription revenue

You must consistently deliver exclusive content to retain subscribers

Subscription fatigue can lead to cancellations

Not all content niches perform equally well with subscriptions

Tips to Succeed

Offer genuinely exclusive content that isn't available elsewhere

Engage with your subscribers personally through subscriber-only chats

Poll your audience to understand what exclusive content they want

Be consistent with your posting schedule

Promote your subscription tier regularly in your regular content

Other Ways to Make Money with Your Phone

1. *Partner With Brands to Create Sponsored Content*

How much you can make: Varies depending on how many followers you have, your content niche and the brands you partner with. According to Influencer Marketing Hub, a nano influencer with less than 10,000 followers can make between $10 and $100 per post.

How it works: Instagram's Creator Marketplace provides a platform for you to connect with brands to form branded content partnerships. Select the brands and interests that are relevant to you, continue posting content to build your following, and brands will invite you to collaborate on paid projects.

Canadian Influencer Rates

Follower Tier	*Follower Range*	*Estimated Earnings per Post*
Nano	*1,000 – 10,000*	*$10 – $100*
Micro	*10,000 – 100,000*	*$100 – $500*
Macro	*100,000 – 1 million*	*$5,000 – $10,000*
Mega	*1 million+*	*$10,000+*

What to Watch Out For

Requires a significant following to attract brand interest

Payment can take 30–90 days

Brands may have strict content guidelines

FTC and Competition Bureau Canada disclosure requirements

Authenticity concerns if you promote too many products

Tips to Succeed

Choose a specific niche to build authority

Create high-quality content consistently

Disclose sponsored content clearly (required by Canadian advertising standards)

Build a media kit highlighting your audience demographics

Reach out to brands directly if they don't find you first

Track engagement metrics to prove your value

1. *Get Gifts From Fans*

How much you can make: US$0.01 for every Star your Reels receive from fans.

How it works: When your fans want to show their support for your content, they can buy virtual gifts to share with you. Fans choose from different gift packages they want to purchase, then leave Stars on your Reels to show their appreciation.

What to Watch Out For

Requires at least 500 followers to be eligible

Earnings are relatively small per Star

Not all content types qualify for gifts

Requires consistent Reels creation

Stars can only be redeemed once you reach a minimum threshold

Tips to Succeed

Create Reels that encourage engagement

Thank fans who send gifts

Experiment with different content types to see what resonates

Cross-promote your Reels on other platforms

Consider creating a series that encourages repeat viewing

1. *Set Up an Instagram Shop*

How much you can make: Varies depending on what you are selling.

How it works: The Shops feature lets you display products for sale on both Instagram and Facebook. This makes it easy for followers to browse your catalogue of products and explore different items. Buyers can check out via Instagram or Facebook, but as of June 2025, Shops is transitioning to directing customers to your own website to check out.

What to Watch Out For

Requires a business account and product catalog

Instagram's transition to website checkout means you need your own e-commerce site

Transaction fees may apply

Requires product photography and descriptions

Customer service responsibilities fall on you

Tips to Succeed

Use high-quality product photos

Write detailed, SEO-friendly product descriptions

Tag products in your posts and Stories

Respond quickly to customer inquiries

Promote your shop regularly in your content

Related: How to make money on TikTok

1. *Affiliate Marketing*

How much you can make: As a rough guide, you can generally expect to earn a commission of between 5% and 20% per sale.

How it works: Affiliate marketers earn a commission by promoting another company's product and generating sales. You can create content about a particular product or brand and include a trackable link or promo code. If your content leads to a sale, you'll get paid a commission.

What to Watch Out For

Requires an audience that trusts your recommendations

Commission rates vary widely by program

Some affiliate programs don't accept Canadian applicants

Tracking issues can result in lost commissions

Requires disclosure of affiliate relationships

Tips to Succeed

Only promote products you genuinely use and believe in

Use link-in-bio tools to manage multiple affiliate links

Create honest reviews and tutorials

Track which content generates the most clicks and sales

Disclose affiliate relationships clearly

1. *Sell Your Own Merch*

How much you can make: Varies greatly depending on how many followers you have and what you're selling. Expect earnings to start at a few dollars per sale.

How it works: You can use Instagram to market and sell merchandise related to your own specific brand and niche. From coffee mugs and bookmarks to t-shirts, hats and hoodies, there's a wide range of gear you can sell to your followers. You can also include catchphrases you regularly use in your content and look for products that suit your target audience—as an example, influencers in the pet niche might develop their own range of designer dog jackets.

What to Watch Out For

Requires upfront investment in inventory or print-on-demand setup

Profit margins can be thin

Requires customer service and fulfillment

Shipping costs for Canadian sellers can be high

Returns and exchanges add complexity

Tips to Succeed

Start with print-on-demand to test demand

Use your catchphrases and inside jokes

Promote merch in your Stories and Reels

Create limited-edition drops to drive urgency

Offer free shipping for orders over a certain amount

Related: How to make money on Pinterest

1. *Create User-Generated Content (UGC)*

How much you can make: Rates start at approximately $50 to $100 per post, but you could potentially earn much more if you have a large following.

How it works: User-generated content (UGC) is content created by real people using products in the real world, as opposed to ads and promotional material developed by brands and advertisers. Once you build a loyal Instagram following by offering honest product reviews and demonstrations, you can pitch yourself to brands who want to increase exposure for their brand with content generated by a trusted authority—you.

What to Watch Out For

Requires a portfolio of content samples

Brands may want full usage rights

Payment terms vary widely

Requires negotiation skills

Can be time-consuming for the payment received

Tips to Succeed

Create a portfolio of UGC samples

Specialize in a specific product category

Offer packages (e.g., 3 posts + 5 Stories)

Set clear usage rights and pricing

Build relationships with brands for repeat work

1. *Promote Your Business*

How much you can make: It really depends on the type of business you run and the products you sell.

How it works: Instagram can be a very useful platform to help you direct traffic to your website and generate sales. Whatever industry you're in—from health and fitness to home repairs and maintenance—sharing informative, educational and entertaining content on Instagram could be an effective way to build goodwill for your business and attract new customers.

What to Watch Out For

Requires consistent content creation

Results take time to materialize

Requires understanding of Instagram's algorithm

Competition from other businesses in your niche

Time investment can be significant

Tips to Succeed

Share behind-the-scenes content

Post customer testimonials and success stories

Use Instagram Stories for time-sensitive promotions

Engage with your local community

Run Instagram Ads to reach new audiences

1. *Become an Instagram Marketing Consultant*

How much you can make: Varies depending on your skills and experience, but you could charge $50 per hour or more.

How it works: Experienced creators and social media experts can earn an income offering Instagram marketing services. You can put your skills to use to help small businesses devise and execute social media strategies, increase their Instagram engagement and boost sales.

What to Watch Out For

Requires proven results on your own account

Client education is often necessary

Results take time

Competition from agencies

Requires ongoing learning as the platform changes

Tips to Succeed

Build your own Instagram presence first

Document your results with metrics

Offer packages at different price points

Specialize in a specific industry

Stay updated on platform changes and trends

1. *Create and Market Online Courses*

How much you can make: Varies.

How it works: If you establish yourself on Instagram as an expert or authority in a specific niche, you can develop and sell online courses related to your area of expertise on Instagram. You could create fitness courses, beauty tutorials, marketing lessons, photography courses, or even a study program on how to up your social media game on Instagram.

What to Watch Out For

Requires significant upfront work to create

Requires video production skills

Platform fees for course hosting

Marketing effort required to drive sales

Student support and updates needed

Tips to Succeed

Validate demand before creating

Start with a mini-course

Use Instagram to promote your course

Offer early-bird pricing to your followers

Build a community around your course

1. *Instagram Live Badges*

How much you can make: US$0.99 – US$4.99 per badge.

How it works: When you go Live on Instagram, viewers can purchase badges to show their support. Badges appear next to the viewer's name during the Live session, and you earn a portion of the revenue. This is a great way to monetize live content and engage with your audience in real time.

What to Watch Out For

Requires consistent Live sessions

Earnings per badge are relatively small

Requires an engaged audience

Not all followers will purchase badges

Instagram takes a percentage of badge revenue

Tips to Succeed

Go Live regularly on a set schedule

Announce Live sessions in advance

Engage with viewers who purchase badges

Offer exclusive content during Lives

Thank badge purchasers publicly

1. *Instagram Creator Marketplace*

How much you can make: Varies depending on brand partnerships.

How it works: The Creator Marketplace is Instagram's official platform connecting creators with brands for sponsored content opportunities. You create a creator profile highlighting your niche, audience demographics, and rates. Brands then browse the marketplace and reach out to creators who fit their campaign needs.

What to Watch Out For

Requires a professional account

Not all creators are accepted

Requires a significant following to attract brand interest

Competition from other creators

Payment terms vary by brand

Tips to Succeed

Complete your creator profile thoroughly

Highlight your audience demographics

Set competitive but fair rates

Respond quickly to brand inquiries

Deliver high-quality content on time

What Are the Best Ways to Make Money on Instagram in Canada?

The best way to make money on Instagram depends on your niche and what you hope to get out of the platform.

That said, the route to success is to develop an audience of highly engaged followers, which will then help you make money from brand partnerships and sponsored content. If you're looking for the highest earning potential, brand partnerships are the way to go. You can also sell Subscriptions to followers who want exclusive content, or bring in extra cash from follower gifts.

But none of these are get-rich-quick options. You'll need to put plenty of effort into building a following before you can monetize your account, which takes time and a proven track record of consistently posting engaging content.

Matching Monetization Methods to Follower Count

Follower Count Best Monetization Options

0 – 500 Affiliate marketing, promoting your own business

500 – 1,000 Gifts from fans, affiliate marketing

1,000 – 10,000 UGC, affiliate marketing, selling merch, Instagram Shops

10,000 – 100,000 Subscriptions, brand partnerships, consulting, courses

100,000+ Brand partnerships, Creator Marketplace, Live badges

How Do People Make a Lot of Money on Instagram in Canada?

Unless someone is already a celeb with a huge fanbase and a long list of sponsors, how do they turn an Instagram account into a big money earner?

The most lucrative money-making opportunity is to partner with brands for sponsored content. But to build a large, loyal and highly engaged follower base, you need to choose a niche and regularly post fun, entertaining and informative content.

Canadian Success Stories

Judith J Kombe – Her posts on motherhood, family and home cleaning are full of positive vibes. She welcomes her audience into the day-to-day aspects of her life, making them feel like part of the family, which has helped her amass 2.8 million Instagram followers.

Mei Pang – Toronto's Mei Pang posts content in an entirely different niche. This heavily tattooed makeup artist shares makeup tutorials showcasing her distinctive style with 3.4 million followers, and she's picked up her fair share of brand partnerships along the way.

Shayan Kaffash – Posts a lot of content devoted to pranking his family. It's easy-going, light-hearted stuff, but it's clearly a hit with Instagram users, as Kaffash has over 3 million followers.

All of which shows that there are many different paths to success. It's all about finding the right niche, something you're passionate about, and getting started.

How Many Followers Do You Need to Make Money on Instagram in Canada?

There is no specific minimum number of followers you need to make money on Instagram. However, you will need a specific number of followers to qualify for some monetization features:

Feature Minimum Followers Required

Instagram Subscriptions 10,000

Gifts from fans (Stars) 500

Creator Marketplace Varies (professional account required)

Live Badges 500

But as you'd expect, more followers means more earning potential from sponsored posts. According to Influencer Marketing Hub:

Nano influencers (less than 10,000 followers): $10 to $100 per post

Micro influencers (10,000 to 100,000 followers): $100 to $500 per post

Macro influencers (100,000 to 1 million followers): $5,000 to $10,000 per post

Mega influencers (1 million+ followers): $10,000+ per post

How Many Views Do You Need to Make Money on Instagram in Canada?

Instagram isn't a pay-per-view platform, so there's no specific "magic number" of views you need to start earning money.

Of course, it goes without saying that the more views, the better. Increased viewership means:

More chances of boosting your follower numbers

A better shot at attracting interest from brands looking to generate sponsored content

More people who might want to subscribe to you, shop at your store or send you gifts

The more views you get—and the more engaged those viewers are with your content through likes, comments and shares—the greater your earning potential.

Canadian Tax Note

All income earned from Instagram monetization is taxable in Canada. The Canada Revenue Agency (CRA) requires you to report all income from all sources, including:

Brand partnership fees

Subscription revenue

Gift and badge income

Affiliate commissions

Merchandise sales

Consulting fees

Course sales

Keep detailed records of your earnings and expenses. You may be able to deduct business expenses like equipment, internet costs, and home office expenses. Consult a Canadian accountant if you're unsure about your obligations.

Frequently Asked Questions

How can beginners make money on Instagram in Canada?

Beginners with small followings can start with affiliate marketing, promoting their own business or services, and creating UGC content for brands. You don't need thousands of followers to start earning—affiliate marketing and UGC are accessible with any audience size. Focus on building a specific niche and engaging with your followers before pursuing brand partnerships.

Can I earn money with Instagram Live badges in Canada?

Yes, Canadian creators can earn money through Instagram Live badges. When you go Live, viewers can purchase badges to show support, and you earn a portion of the revenue. Badges typically cost between US$0.99 and US$4.99. You need at least 500 followers to be eligible. Instagram takes a percentage of badge revenue, and payouts are made in USD.

Can I make money with Instagram bonuses in Canada?

Instagram bonuses (also known as Reels Play bonuses) have been available in select markets, but availability in Canada has varied. These programs pay creators based on views of their Reels. Check your Instagram Professional Dashboard to see if you're eligible for any bonus programs in your region. If bonuses aren't available in Canada, focus on Subscriptions, gifts, brand partnerships, and affiliate marketing.

Does Instagram pay in Canada?

Yes, Instagram pays Canadian creators through various monetization features. Payments are made in USD via direct deposit or PayPal. Instagram takes a percentage of revenue from Subscriptions, gifts, badges, and some other features. Canadian creators are responsible for reporting this income to the CRA and paying

applicable taxes.

How many followers do I need to monetize Instagram in Canada?

You can start monetizing with any number of followers through affiliate marketing and promoting your own business. For specific features: 500 followers for gifts and Live badges, 10,000 followers for Subscriptions. Brand partnerships typically require at least 1,000–10,000 engaged followers in a specific niche.

Is Instagram monetization available to all Canadian creators?

Most monetization features are available to Canadian creators, but some programs (like certain bonus programs) may have limited availability by region. Subscriptions, gifts, badges, Shops, and affiliate marketing are generally available in Canada. Always check your Instagram Professional Dashboard for features available to your account.

How long does it take to make money on Instagram in Canada?

Building a following and monetizing it takes time. Most creators need 6–12 months of consistent posting to build a meaningful following. Some monetization methods (affiliate marketing, UGC) can generate income within weeks, while brand partnerships typically require several months of audience building.

Do I need a business account to make money on Instagram?

A professional (business or creator) account is recommended for most monetization features. A creator account gives you access to analytics, Creator Marketplace, and monetization tools. Business accounts are better for selling products through Instagram Shops. You can switch between account types in your settings.

Bottom Line

There are multiple ways to make money on Instagram in Canada, whether you're just starting out or already have a significant following. From Subscriptions and brand partnerships to affiliate marketing and selling your own merch, the platform offers diverse monetization opportunities for Canadian creators.

The key to success is building an engaged audience in a specific niche. Focus on creating high-quality content, engaging with your followers, and consistently showing up. Once you have a loyal following, brand partnerships become the most lucrative monetization path.

Remember that all Instagram income is taxable in Canada and must be reported to the CRA. Keep detailed records of your earnings and expenses, and consult a tax professional if needed.

Whether you want to earn a few extra dollars per month or build a full-time career as a content creator, Instagram offers legitimate opportunities for Canadians willing to put in the effort.

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